



The Church Before and After Pentecost

FROM GATHERED TO EMPOWERED, FROM INSTRUCTED TO SENT

Pentecost did not change the Gospel—it changed everything about the Church. The Holy Spirit transformed a waiting group into a witnessing people.

BEFORE PENTECOST (ACTS 1:1–8)		AFTER PENTECOST (ACTS 2 AND BEYOND)	
 GATHERED, NOT EMPOWERED The disciples were together, following Jesus' instructions.	→ 	EMPOWERED BY THE SPIRIT The Holy Spirit came with power and filled them (Acts 2:1–4).	
 INSTRUCTED Jesus taught them about the Kingdom of God.	→ 	ILLUMINATED The Spirit opened their understanding (Luke 24:45).	
 FEARFUL Doors were locked; they were afraid of the Jews (John 20:19).	→ 	BOLD They spoke with courage and were unashamed (Acts 4:13).	
 FOCUSED INSIDE Their world was small—Jerusalem and Israel.	→ 	FOCUSED OUTWARD Their mission reached Judea, Samaria, and the ends of the earth.	
 DEPENDENT ON JESUS' PHYSICAL PRESENCE They walked with Him in person.	→ 	DEPENDENT ON THE SPIRIT'S PRESENCE Jesus returned, and the Spirit came to be with them always.	
 NO SPIRITUAL GIFTS They had not yet received the promised power.	→ 	EQUIPPED WITH GIFTS The Spirit gave gifts for service and building the body (1 Cor. 12:7).	
 WAITING FOR THE PROMISE They were told to wait (Acts 1:4).	→ 	FULFILLMENT OF THE PROMISE Pentecost fulfilled Jesus' promise (Acts 1:8; 2:33).	
 A GROUP OF BELIEVERS A beginning community of faith and hope.	→ 	THE CHURCH IS BORN A Spirit-empowered body with identity, purpose, and mission.	

THE TRANSFORMATION IN ACTION

FROM WAITING TO WITNESSING	THROUGH THE HOLY SPIRIT	TO BOLD PROCLAMATION	TO WORLDWIDE IMPACT
• Hiding • Afraid • Silent • Local • Uncertain	• Empowered • Equipped • Enlightened • Endued with Power • United in Purpose	• Speaking • Courageous • Unashamed • Mission-Focused • Spirit-Led	• Nations • Generations • Churches • Lives Changed • Kingdom Advanced



THE BIG PICTURE

Pentecost marks the divine shift from preparation to power. The same Jesus. The same Gospel. The same mission—now with the Holy Spirit in full operation through His people. The Church was never meant to be a spectator. She was meant to be a witness.



TEACHER NOTE

Use this chart to help learners see the dramatic change the Holy Spirit brought at Pentecost. Encourage discussion about how the same Spirit wants to empower the Church today for the same mission: to glorify Christ and make disciples of all nations.

KEY VERSES

Acts 1:4–5

"And being assembled together with them, He commanded them not to depart from Jerusalem, but to wait for the Promise of the Father..."

Acts 2:1–4

"They were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other tongues as the Spirit gave them utterance."

Acts 4:31

"And when they had prayed, the place where they were assembled together was shaken; and they were all filled with the Holy Spirit..."

Acts 1:8

"But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you; and you will be my witnesses..."

John 16:7

"Nevertheless I tell you the truth: It is to your advantage that I go away; for if I do not go away, the Helper will not come to you; but if I depart, I will send Him to you."

KEY TRUTHS

- Pentecost was the turning point of the Church.
- The Holy Spirit did not replace the disciples—He empowered them.
- The mission did not change—the method and power did.
- What began in the Upper Room was never meant to stay there.
- The Church is a Spirit-empowered people on mission.

RELATED RESOURCES

-  **Articles**
See related RC1 articles online.
-  **Visual Theology**
View the Pentecost Timeline Overview Diagram.
-  **Workbook**
Complete the RC1 study guide.
-  **Glossary**
See: Holy Spirit, Pentecost, Empowerment, Mission.